

Measuring Student Learning in the Age of AI: A Framework and Recommendations for BYU-Idaho

Executive Summary (one page)

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The problem. Generative AI changed the economics of assessment. A credible essay, problem set, or block of code now takes seconds to produce, so the student product no longer proves what a student knows. The common reflex, detect and ban, has failed: AI detectors are inaccurate, biased against non-native English, Black, and neurodivergent students, easily evaded, and cannot prove their own results. US institutions such as Vanderbilt and the University of Pittsburgh have disabled them. Faculty and students are also unsure where legitimate AI use ends and cheating begins.

The reframe. The task is not to police AI but to design assessment that measures learning. This is a validity problem, not just an integrity one.

What the evidence says. Across US, UK, and Australian scholarship and sector guidance (2023 to 2026), the strongest and most consistent finding is that detection fails and authentic work alone is not AI-proof. The leading design response separates *secured* tasks (AI-free, to verify individual understanding) from *open* tasks (AI allowed, to assess judgment and process). Oral and interactive assessment both verifies understanding and strengthens teacher-student relationships. Emerging tools such as voice agents and AI-assisted vivas are promising but early; use them to practice, not to grade.

Where BYU-Idaho stands. BYU-Idaho already avoids AI detectors and requires students to disclose and cite AI use, a strong base. The gaps are structural: no shared method for deciding which tasks to secure AI-free versus assess AI-augmented, no common AI-use scale, and the key faculty how-to resources sit behind login. The recommendations below, and specific fixes to the AI website (byui.edu/ai), close those gaps.

Recommendation: a two-horizon path.

Short-term wins, this term:

- Stop using detection scores as evidence of misconduct; take an educative stance.
- Add one secured checkpoint (in-person or oral) per course.
- State permitted AI use for each task, using one common AI-use scale.
- Shift some grade weight from the product to the process.

Long-term adjustments, one to two years:

- Move assessment security to the program level: secure a few key moments, not every task.
- Redesign assessment in teams, not alone.

- Fund and sustain a shared faculty resource repository.
- Run a program-level pilot with evaluation.

Three aims served. More valid assessment of learning; stronger teacher-student relationships; and graduates ready to use AI well in work, community, and home.

The ask. We ask the committee and administration to endorse the validity-first framework, resource the repository and team redesign, authorize a program-level pilot, and update the AI website so faculty can act on it.

Full report, evidence base, and references: `Measuring Student Learning in the Age of AI.docx`.